

PDF Merge & Compress Tool

Step-by-step guide for non-technical users

□ Privacy first: Your PDF files never leave your computer. Everything runs locally — no uploads, no internet connection needed after setup.

Step 1 — Install Node.js (one time only)

Node.js is a free program that lets you run JavaScript scripts on your computer. You only need to install it once.

How to install:

1. Open your browser and go to: <https://nodejs.org>
2. Click the big green button that says "LTS" (recommended for most users).
3. Download the installer and double-click it when it finishes.
4. Click "Next" through all the steps and then "Install". Leave all default options as-is.
5. When it finishes, click Finish.

□ You do NOT need to understand what Node.js is. Think of it like installing a driver — you install it once and forget about it.

Step 2 — Set Up the Tool (one time only)

Before using the scripts for the first time, you need to download one small library they depend on.

How to do it:

6. Open the folder where the scripts are saved (e.g. your Desktop → 'merge pdfs' folder).
7. Click on the address bar at the top of the File Explorer window (where the folder path is shown).
8. Type: `cmd` and press Enter. A black Command Prompt window will open.
9. Type the following and press Enter:

```
npm install
```

10. Wait for it to finish. You will see some text scroll by — this is normal.

□ *This creates a folder called 'node_modules' next to the scripts. Do not delete it. You never need to run npm install again.*

Step 3 — Merging PDFs

Use this when you want to combine multiple PDF files into one.

Where to put your files

Place all the PDF files you want to merge into the folder called:

```
toMerge
```

This folder is located next to the script file. The files will be merged in alphabetical order by filename, so rename them if you want a specific order (e.g. 01_contract.pdf, 02_appendix.pdf).

How to run it

11. Open the Command Prompt in the scripts folder (same as Step 2 above).

12. Type the following and press Enter:

```
node mergeScript.js
```

13. Wait a few seconds. You will see each file listed as it is added.

14. When it says ✓ Saved, the merged file is ready.

Where is the result?

The merged file is saved as:

```
merged.pdf
```

It will appear in the same folder as the script, not inside toMerge.

□ *Your original files inside toMerge are not deleted or changed.*

Step 4 — Compressing a PDF

Use this when a PDF file is too large — for example a scanned document with high-quality images.

Where to put your file

Place the PDF you want to compress into the folder called:

```
toCompress
```

This folder is located next to the script file. You can compress one or multiple files at once — just put them all in the folder.

How to run it

15. Open the Command Prompt in the scripts folder.

16. Type the following and press Enter:

```
node compressPdf.js
```

17. Wait — large files can take 30 seconds to a few minutes.

18. When it says ✓ Done, the compressed file is ready.

Where is the result?

The compressed file is saved inside the toCompress folder with _compressed added to the name. For example:

- Original: Maksim_contract.pdf
- Compressed: Maksim_contract_compressed.pdf

□ *Your original file is NOT deleted. The compressed version is a separate file saved alongside it.*

Step 5 — Typical Workflow (Merge then Compress)

If you want to merge several files and then compress the result, do this in order:

19. Put all your PDFs into the toMerge folder.

20. Run: `node mergeScript.js`

21. Move the resulting merged.pdf into the toCompress folder.

22. Run: `node compressPdf.js`

23. Your final compressed merged PDF will be in toCompress as merged_compressed.pdf.

Quick Reference

What you want to do	Put files in	Command to run
Merge PDFs	toMerge folder	<code>node mergeScript.js</code>
Compress a PDF	toCompress folder	<code>node compressPdf.js</code>

Troubleshooting

'node' is not recognized

Node.js is not installed or the terminal was open before installing it. Close the Command Prompt window, reopen it, and try again. If it still fails, reinstall Node.js from nodejs.org.

'Cannot find module' error

You haven't run `npm install` yet, or you ran it in the wrong folder. Make sure the Command Prompt is open inside the scripts folder, then run:

```
npm install
```

File not found error

Double-check that your PDF is inside the correct folder (toMerge or toCompress) and that the filename has no typos. File names are case-sensitive.

Compression doesn't reduce size much

Try changing 'ebook' to 'screen' inside `compressPdf.js` for more aggressive compression. Open the file in Notepad, find the word 'ebook', change it to 'screen', save, and run the script again.

All processing is local. Your files are never uploaded anywhere.